



LUBIN SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

Course Information:

Course Title: Disruptive Technology & Innovation

Course Number and Section: MBA 816 (CRN 71930)

Term: Spring 2025

Time: Thursdays 5:40pm – 8:30pm

Class delivery format/location: On Campus

Location: 1 Pace Plaza – Room: W515

Instructor Information

Instructor: Dr. Birgit Elchoueri

Email: belchoueri@pace.edu

Phone: (646) 703 2276

Office hours: Room W409E

Monday: 12:10pm – 1:10pm

Tuesday: 12:40pm – 1:40pm

Thursday: 12:40pm – 1:40pm and 3:30pm – 5:30pm

Preferred Contact Method: Email (students can expect a response within 24 hours)

Course description

This course explores the impact of cutting-edge technologies on organizations. Technology innovations such as Blockchain, biotechnology, artificial intelligence, and automation continue to disrupt the business landscape in industries from financial services to fashion. These technologies are changing operations, management, and supply chain management. To become an effective manager and leader in this turbulent environment, it is important to understand these new technologies and the innovation process to better manage organizations in industries facing disruption.

Course Learning Objectives

1. Explore new technologies and patterns of innovation
2. Analyze the impact of technological change on industries and organizations
3. Utilize the creative thinking process to new product development
4. Apply human centered design thinking to the innovation process
5. Demonstrate how an organization can adapt to new technologies using change management techniques
6. Explore / develop strategies that allow organizations to embrace disruptive technologies that threaten their current way of doing business
7. Analyze how firms incorporate the concepts of innovation and disruptive technology to stay ahead of your competitors

Instructional Materials & Tools

The course will utilize the Learning Management System “CLASSES”. For an overview of how to use CLASSES, please go to the following website on the Pace University page:

[Information Technology Services | Brightspace](#)

REQUIRED: Custom course packet with four business cases on new technologies with special focus on how organizations manage technological disruptions.

Harvard Business Case Study Course Pack

Click on URL for access to purchase the course pack: <https://hbsp.harvard.edu/import/1325204>

Grading Policy

Grades for this course will be determined through several individual and team assignments. I recognize that different kinds of assignments feed into the strengths of different students, and I work to provide a range of opportunities for you to show what you've learned. Please read / watch all assigned reading materials, so that you can make meaningful contributions to class discussions while actively listening to lectures, TED Talks and other videos.

Assignment	% of Course Grade
Written Assignment: 1 assignment	10%
Midterm Exam: MC Questions	20%
Final Exam: MC Questions	20%
Participation: In-class contribution (70%) & 3 discussions (30%)	20%
Tech Trend Report: Presentation (10 min max)	5%
Team Innovation Project Plan: 4 components / details outlined in Course Schedule and Deliverables section (50% Group Project Grade / 40% Individual Presentation / 10% Peer Evaluation Grade)	25%
TOTAL	100%

Pace University's grading scale (%) is as follows:

A	93% and above	B-	80%-82%
A-	90%-92%	C+	77%-79%
B+	87%-89%	C	73%-76%
B	83%-86%	C-	70%-72%

Written Assignment (1): (10% of course grade)

Assignment instructions will be posted in each Module on Classes. The written assignment should follow APA 7th edition format and is submitted as a word document on the designated assignment section on Classes. The penalty for a late submission of the written assignment is a reduction of 10% of the maximum applicable mark for the assignment per day that the assignment is late.

Midterm Exam: (20% of course grade)

The midterm examination consists of 60 multiple-choice questions with a time limit of 90 minutes. Exam questions cover the concepts that are discussed during the lecture part of the course.

Final Exam: (20% of course grade)

The final examination is not cumulative and consists of 60 multiple-choice questions with a time limit of 90 minutes. Exam questions cover the concepts that are discussed during the lecture part of the course post midterm.

Participation: (20% of course grade)

In-class contribution (70%)

Class attendance and active participation are crucial! Students with more than **three unexcused** absences will lose 2 points off their final grade for each missed class with no acceptable excuse after the first three unexcused absences. Excused absences will require appropriate documentation, as determined by the professor, and such documentation must be provided within 24 hours of the missed class. Students are expected to read all assigned reading materials, so that they make meaningful contributions to class discussions while actively listening to discussions and lectures. **Please provide me with advanced notice if you must miss a class.**

This course provides you with an opportunity to verbalize your ideas, reflect on your fellow students' ideas and make business decisions as part of a team, which are essential skills in the workplace. Throughout the semester, we will examine four case studies that highlight key concepts from the course. Students will receive preparation instructions in advance of each case discussion to review and analyze the material beforehand. Active participation in these discussions is essential and will significantly contribute to your overall participation grade. Engaging thoughtfully with the cases and contributing to class dialogue is expected of all students. You will receive your in-class participation grade (70% of the Course Participation Grade) at the end of the semester. Participation is graded based on your unique and constructive contribution to the classroom experience and merely attending class does not constitute contribution.

3 Online discussions (30%)

Lively discussions (3 discussion forums) and sharing of information enable you to learn content, but they will also provide an experience that represents daily managerial responsibilities. The best leaders think carefully about the issues at hand before they make decisions and remain open to new insights. They listen to what others have to say, develop logical arguments, communicate those arguments in a clear manner and can “sell” their views and proposals to their teams. This course provides you with an opportunity to verbalize your ideas, reflect on your fellow students' ideas and make business decisions as part of a team, which are essential skills in the workplace. Proofread and check the spelling before submitting a post on the Discussion Forum. While online communication is more relaxed, it is not careless communication. Conducting quick proofing of your work before you send it may alleviate the need to clarify your posting and save you some time and potential embarrassment. Be aware of copyright and “fair use” law; do not plagiarize, and don't forget to cite your information.

Tech Trend Report (5% of course grade)

Students will select a current technology trend and research its impact on daily life, business, and society. Each student will deliver a presentation (maximum 10 minutes) either live in class or as a pre-recorded video posted on Classes. A list of suggested tech trend topics and the presentation schedule will be shared during Week 2. Students may submit up to three preferred topics; final assignments will be made on a first-come, first-served basis.

Team Innovation Project Plan (25% course grade)

The Innovation Plan is a team project that will require diligent project management, including progress tracking, status reporting and a final project presentation. After forming teams (Module 2), you will together enhance the team's potential for innovation and integration, and practice your skills through a comprehensive, integrative analysis and strategic implementation presentation. Each team explores an innovation (a new technology or a new technique or practice). The project will not only investigate what it is, but what's next. You will take a point of view as a team and develop a diffusion strategy for service / product innovation.

The specific and defined deliverables will be posted in the respective modules.

- Module 2: Characteristics as a Team Member Summary
- Module 3: The Innovation Plan Project Management
- Module 4: Project Plan Progress Report
- Module 7: The Innovation Plan Final Presentation (Group & Individual components make up the final grade)

The final recorded group presentation should be approximately 20 min. addressing the following:

- Identify the nature of the innovation (digital/tech)
- Describe the source of the innovation
- Discuss which industries, businesses, and/or communities will be affected by this innovation
- Discuss the development stage of the innovation
- Examine what technology or practice might it replace
- Conduct a stakeholder analysis (who is impacted by this innovation and how)
- Identify factors that will influence the diffusion of the innovation
- Take the position of an organization working to launch/diffuse the innovation
- Develop a deployment strategy that enhances the likelihood of success.

All team members will receive the same score for the Group Project Presentation. The overall grading breakdown is as follows: Group Project Presentation: 50%, Individual Presentation: 40%, and Peer Evaluation: 10%. Detailed rubrics for each component are available on Classes.

The Peer Evaluation Template will be provided on Classes and must be completed by each student to assess their teammates' contributions honestly and thoroughly. Your individual Peer Evaluation grade will be the average of the scores given by your fellow group members. Peer evaluations will be treated as confidential and anonymous. **If you encounter significant issues with a team member and cannot resolve them within the group, please contact me as soon as possible so we can address the situation promptly.**

COURSE SCHEDULE AND DELIVERABLES:

Each of the 7 course modules will be completed in two weeks. We will run on a Thursday through Wednesday rotation. An exception to this is the discussion forum, for which **initial and final posts** are due on **Sundays**. The **Assignment Name** corresponds to the title of the assignment in Classes. **Please note: Each student prepares an individual Trend Report (100 points / 5% of Total Grade), instructions can be found on Classes.**

Module Start/ End	Module	Assignment Name	Assignment Type	Due Date
Sept 4 – Sept 17 Class: 9/4 & 9/11	Module 1	Course Introduction	Discussion Forum 1	1 st post due 09/07 (11:59pm) 2 nd post due 09/14 (11:59pm)
Sept 4 – Sept 17	Module 1	Tech Trend Topic Submission on Classes	Ungraded Submission	09/07 (11:59pm)
Sept 4 – Sept 17	Module 1	Personal Portfolio: Creativity Assessment and Reflection	Written Assignment	09/17 (11:59pm)
Sept 18 – Oct 1 Class: 9/18 & 9/25	Module 2	Case Study1: Read case and prepare for class discussion	Case Analysis	In Class discussion 9/25
Sept 18 – Oct 1	Module 2	The Innovation Plan: Team Member Characteristics	Team Project 1	Upload by 10/09 (11:59pm)
NO CLASS on Oct 2				
Oct 9 – Oct 22 Class:10/9 & 10/16	Module 3	The Innovation Plan: Project Management	Team Project 2	Upload 10/16 (11:59pm)
Oct 9 – Oct 22	Module 3	Case Study2: Read case and prepare for class discussion	Case Analysis	In Class discussion 10/16
Oct 23 – Nov 5 Class: 10/23 & 10/30	Module 4	Investing in Innovations	Discussion Forum 2	1 st post due 10/26 (11:59pm) 2 nd post due 11/07 (11:59pm)
Oct 23 – Nov 5	Module 4	The Innovation Plan: Project Progress Report	Team Project 3	Upload by 10/30 (11:59pm)
Oct 23 – Nov 5	Module 4	MIDTERM EXAM In-Class exam 10/30	EXAM	90 min exam during scheduled class time

Nov 6 - Nov 19 Class: 11/6 & 11/13	Module 5	Case Study3: Read case and prepare for class discussion	Case Analysis	In Class discussion 11/6
Nov 6 - Nov 19	Module 5	Case Study4: Read case and prepare for class discussion	Case Analysis	In Class discussion 11/13
Nov 20 – Dec 10 Class: 11/20 & 12/4	Module 6	The Innovation Plan: Presentation (recorded)	Team Project 5 Group Grade	Upload by 12/10 (11:59pm)
Nov 20 – Dec 10	Module 6	The Innovation Plan: Presentation & Peer Evaluation	Team Project 5 Individual Grade	Upload by 12/10 (11:59pm)
Dec 11 – Dec 18 Class: 12/11 & 12/18	Module 7	Group Innovation Plan Presentation Review	Discussion Forum 3	2 postings due 12/17 (11:59pm)
Dec 11 – Dec 18 Final Exam	Module 7	FINAL EXAM: In-Class exam: Dec 18	EXAM	90 min exam during scheduled class time

	Individual Assignment
	Team Assignment
	Discussion Forum
	Exams
	Case Discussion

University Policies and Resources

Plagiarism

Cheating or plagiarism will result in a score of zero for the assignment or test, possibly failure for the course at the discretion of the Dean. Pace University policy will apply in all cases.

Academic Integrity

Students in this course are required to adhere to Pace University's [Academic Integrity Code \(PDF\)](#) , which supports honesty and ethical conduct in the educational process. It educates students about what constitutes academic misconduct, helps to deter cheating and plagiarism, and provides a procedure for handling cases of academic misconduct. Students are expected to be familiar with the Code, which can be found in [Policies and Procedures](#). Individual schools and programs may have additional standards of academic integrity. Students are responsible for familiarizing themselves with the policies of the schools, programs, and courses in which they are enrolled.

Instructions for faculty, a paper about best practices, and the form for reporting integrity policy violations are posted on the Provost's webpage under “[Academic Policies and Forms](#).” Reporting forms should be sent to the Chairs of the Academic Conduct Committee on each campus.

Learning Commons

[The Learning Commons](#) uses an array of programs and a holistic approach to assist students with academic skills and content knowledge. We are dedicated to developing independent learners through purposeful interactions with trained, well-qualified peer and professional staff. Services offered:

- Content Support Services including, content tutoring, exam review sessions, & content preparation/support workshops
- Academic Skills Services including small group peer mentoring, academic skills workshops, and individual academic development
- Writing Support Services including, writing tutoring & writing preparation/support workshops

Public Health

Public health information and policies for the campus community are available on the [Respiratory Virus \(COVID-19, Flu, RSV\) Guidance](#) page. Pace recommends everyone continue to take steps to protect not only themselves but their colleagues, friends, and the campus by practicing good hand hygiene, staying home if you are sick, being up to date on vaccinations and boosters, and wearing a mask indoors when recommended by the CDC.

Pace University remains a mask-friendly community where mask use is always encouraged and supported. You may choose to wear a face mask, but they are not required outside of sick visits to healthcare settings.

Procedure for Students Who Wish to Obtain Reasonable Accommodations for a Course:

The same rigorous admission and academic standards apply to students with and without a disability. In order to support the continued success of students with disabilities, the University prohibits discrimination on the basis of disability and is committed to providing equal access for students with disabilities to its facilities, programs, and activities. The University's commitment to equal educational opportunities for students with disabilities includes providing reasonable accommodations for the needs

of students with disabilities.

To request an accommodation for a qualifying disability, a student must self-identify and register with the [Student Accessibility Services Office \(SAS\)](#) for their campus. Student Accessibility Services is housed in the Counseling Center on both the New York City and Pleasantville campuses. Student Accessibility Services for the New York City campus may be contacted at (212) 346-1526, (212) 346-1199 or 161 William St, 10th Flr. Student Accessibility Services for the Westchester campuses may be contacted at (914) 773-3710, (914) 773 -3201 or the Administration Center, 861 Bedford Road, Pleasantville. No one, including faculty, is authorized to evaluate the need and arrange for an accommodation except the Student Accessibility Services staff. Moreover, no one, including faculty, is authorized to contact Student Accessibility Services on behalf of a student.

To request an accommodation for a pregnancy or a pregnancy-related condition, a student must self-identify and contact Bernard Dufresne, the University's [Title IX Coordinator](#), at bdufresne@pace.edu. For more information, please visit the University's [Pregnancy Adjustments and Accommodations for Students](#) webpage.

Technological Resources:

- List of all [Pace Information Technology Services](#).
- For assistance with a technological concern contact the Pace Helpdesk at (914) 773-3648 or create a [help desk ticket](#).
- Visit the [Learning Remotely website](#)

Appropriate Use Policy for Information Technology:

Pace endorses the following statement on software and intellectual rights distributed by EDUCAUSE, the non-profit consortium of colleges and universities, committed to the use and management of information technology in higher education. The statement reads:

Respect for intellectual labor and creativity is vital to academic discourse and enterprise. This principle applies to work of all authors and publishers in all media. It encompasses respect for the right to acknowledgment, right to privacy and right to determine the form, manner and terms of publication and distribution.

Because electronic information is volatile and easily reproduced, respect for the work and personal expression of others is especially critical in computer environments. Violations of authorial integrity, including plagiarism, invasion of privacy, unauthorized access and trade secret and copyright violations, may be grounds for sanctions against members of the academic community.

[Pace's appropriate use policy](#) applies to recordings of classroom instruction and digital artifacts created by faculty and students.

Sex-Based Misconduct Policy and Procedure:

Pace University is committed to providing a safe environment for every member of its community and to ensuring that no student, faculty or staff member is excluded from participation in or denied the benefits of any University program or activity on the basis of sex. Accordingly, the University prohibits the following forms of Sex-Based Misconduct: sexual assault, sexual harassment, gender-based harassment, dating violence, domestic violence, sexual exploitation and stalking.

Instructors have an obligation to report any information about sex discrimination, including all sex-

based misconduct to the Assistant Vice President of the Office of Institutional Equity and Title IX Compliance – Bernard Dufresne, bdufresne@pace.edu, 41 Park Row, 14th floor, (212) 346-1310. The Title IX Coordinator is responsible for investigating violations of the sex-based misconduct policy. Go here for more information about the [Pace University sexual misconduct policy](#).

Members of the University community who believe that they have been subjected to Sex-Based Misconduct are encouraged to report such incidents to the University using the University's [Online Reporting System](#) and, where applicable, to local law enforcement. **Confidential** resources include the **University Counseling Centers, Offices of Sexual and Interpersonal Wellness and University Healthcare**. Contact information for those offices may be found in the self-care section below.

Self-Care:

Your academic success in this course and throughout your college career depends heavily on your personal health and well-being. Stress is a common part of the college experience, and it often can be compounded by unexpected life changes outside the classroom. The Pace Community strongly encourages you to take care of yourself throughout the term, before the demands of midterms and finals reach their peak.

The [Counseling Center Emergency](#) page supplies potentially life-saving mental health information to Pace University students, staff, and faculty, putting vital information and support options at your fingertips, just in case you or a friend needs help. You can also find this information in the MyPace and PaceSafe apps. Students are also strongly encouraged to download the [WellTrack Boost App](#). It is a free, self-guided, clinically supported app that includes self-assessments and self-help resources on various mental health topics, mood checks, and other therapeutic tools. To download this confidential app, please go to <https://pace.welltrack-boost.com> and sign in with your Pace email.

Department	Pleasantville	New York City
Advising Center for Exploring Majors	First-year: (914) 773-3756 or (914) 773-3757	(212) 346-1798
Affirmative Action Office	(914) 923-2610	(212) 346-1310
Center for Wellbeing	(914) 773-3849	
College of Health Professions Academic Advisement	UG (914) 773-3436 UG (914) 773-3301 Grad (914) 773-3114	UG (212) 618-6027 Grad (914) 773-3114
Counseling Center	(914) 773-3710 (914) 773-3201	(212) 346-1526 (212) 346-1199
Dean for Students Office	(914) 773-3351	(212) 346-1306
Dyson College Academic Advisement	(914) 773-3781	(212) 346-1518
International Student/Scholars	(212) 346-1368	

Lubin School of Business Academic Advisement	UG (914) 773-3531	UG / Grad (212) 618-6550
New Student Experience and Transitions	(914) 773-3756	(212) 346-1219 and (212) 346-1346
Office of Multicultural Affairs	(914) 773-3628 (914) 773-3775	(212) 346-1546
Office of the Registrar	help.pace.edu	
Office of Sexual and Interpersonal Wellness	(212) 346-1931 (914) 773-3628 (914) 773-8783	
Pace Women's Justice Center	(914) 287-0739	
Pforzheimer Honors College Academic Advisement	(212) 346-1697 (914) 773-3848	
Residential Life	(914) 597-8777 (914) 773-3676	(212) 346-1295
Seidenberg School Academic Advisement	(212) 346 1946	
Study Abroad	(212) 346-1368	
Student Accessibility Services	(914) 773-3710	(212) 346-1526
Student Accounts	(877) 672-1830	
Student Engagement	(914) 773-3767	(212) 346-1590
University Health Care	(914) 773-3760	(212) 346-1600